STOIC FOUNDATIONS

The Stoic Collection

Books in this series share one method family: **SEE → SORT → OWN → CHOOSE → REVIEW**. Each title trains a different pressure domain.

Book	Title / focus
Book 1 (this book)	**Stoic Foundations** — install the method: judgment, control, and assent
Book 2	**Stoic Shadow Work Journal** — self-examination of hidden patterns and avoidance
Later titles	New pressure domains; same method family

This is the official starting book. You do not need a prior Collection title. Later books assume this method or supply a short Primer.

STOIC FOUNDATIONS

A Guided Workbook on Judgment, Control, and Assent

The Stoic Collection — Book 1

UnlovedProductions

Stoic Foundations

The Stoic Collection — Book 1

Author / Imprint: UnlovedProductions

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- Marcus Aurelius, **Meditations**: George Long (1890)
- Seneca, **De Ira** (**Of Anger**): Aubrey Stewart (1889), in **Minor Dialogues Together with the Dialogue On Clemency** (George Bell and Sons)

Quotations from Epictetus and Marcus Aurelius follow George Long (1890). Quotations from Seneca, **Of Anger**, follow Aubrey Stewart (1889). These translations are in the public domain in the United States.

See **Sources & Citations** for full bibliographic keys. Quotation verification follows the Book 1 Source Verification Report. Popular internet "Stoic quotes" without primary-text verification are excluded.

Disclaimer — Read before use

What this book is

A philosophical guided workbook based on Stoic ideas of impression, judgment, control, assent, and deliberate action. It is educational and practical. It is intended for adults who want a usable method, not a quote anthology or blank lined paper.

What this book is not

- Not psychotherapy, counseling, coaching, or clinical treatment
- Not medical, psychiatric, or psychological advice
- Not a trauma-processing protocol or crisis intervention tool
- Not a diagnostic instrument
- Not a mystical, occult, or "beginner spirituality" workbook
- Not a shadow-work / avoidance / self-deception title (that is Book 2)
- Not a substitute for licensed professional care
- Not a guarantee of any outcome, improvement, or emotional result

Results vary. Practice on the page is not clinical care. If material in these exercises becomes overwhelming, stop and seek appropriate help.

If you need help now

If you are in crisis, unsafe, or having thoughts of harming yourself or others, do not rely on this book. Contact a qualified professional, local emergency services, or a local crisis line immediately. In the United States, you can call or text **988** (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline). Outside the U.S., use your local emergency number or equivalent crisis services.

Integrity note

Where this book uses workbook structures (cards, sorts, pauses, commitments), those structures are **publishing-created frameworks**. They are not ancient Stoic texts. Classical teachings are distinguished from modern interpretation throughout.

• **Timebox.** Plan 20–40 minutes per chapter session. Finish a chapter in one sitting when you can.

• **Write a concrete incident from this week.** Ordinary scenes beat slogans. Traffic, a late reply, a short meeting, a kitchen mess — those count.

• **Facts first.** When a prompt asks for facts, do not tidy the story to look Stoic.

• **One Practice Commitment per chapter.** Keep it observable. Vague vows do not count.

• **Honesty without self-abuse.** Ownership is not humiliation. Correction is not prosecution.

• **If you stop.** Use the Re-entry Page (p. vii). Restart without drama.

• **Reference sections are part of the book.** Use the Terminology Guide when a term is unclear. Trace quotes in Sources & Citations. Continue with Further Reading if you want depth.

Materials: pen, this book, one incident from this week.

After this book you will be able to run five moves on an ordinary incident. The chapters teach the tools. This page only names the moves.

Move	In one sentence
SEE	Notice the impression as it strikes — before you treat it as the truth.
SORT	Separate facts from added judgments; sort what is up to you from what is not.
OWN	Take accurate responsibility for your assent and your act — not for what was never yours.
CHOOSE	Pick one next act and test it against virtue.
REVIEW	Examine the day; extract one correction.

The loop name **SEE → SORT → OWN → CHOOSE → REVIEW (SSOCR)** is a publishing method used in this Collection. It is not an ancient slogan. Chapters 1–8 install it.

Use this page when you lapse. Do not restart the book from shame.

Date of return:

What broke the chain (facts only):

ASSENT PAUSE on the lapse itself (three-step box taught in Chapter 5 — use it here when you return)

Impression:

Pause used (breaths / cue):

Remainder (unassented):

Next Practice Commitment

Cue:

Act:

Evidence I did it:

Window:

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This book is a finishable program that installs a usable Stoic method.

Its job is practical: take you from slogan familiarity to running a repeatable loop on ordinary life incidents — the late message, the traffic, the short reply, the meeting that ran long.

You will not collect inspirational maxims. You will work one week of real scenes through:

impression → judgment → control → assent → review

Stoic philosophy supplies the minimum doctrine required to run that loop: impressions, opinions, the dichotomy of control, assent, virtue as a test of the next act, and a tradition of evening self-examination.[S1][S2][S5][S7][S12]

By the last page you should be able to say, honestly: **I can see the impression, sort what is mine, pause before I agree, own my share, choose one act, and review the day — without another book in my hand.**

This is **not**:

- A Stoic quote anthology with a few blanks
- A blank or low-content daily journal
- An academic primer with exercises bolted on
- Mystical beginner spirituality
- A shadow-work / avoidance / self-deception title (that is Book 2 of this Collection)
- A trauma-processing or clinical protocol
- Permission to go numb and call it philosophy
- Graduation from Stoicism

If you need clinical care, get clinical care. Philosophy is not a substitute.

If you came to map what you usually hide from yourself, keep this book for the method, then use Book 2. This volume's gym is **ordinary incidents**, not inner heat as the spine.

The Collection trains one portable engine:

SEE → SORT → OWN → CHOOSE → REVIEW (SSOCR)

That name is **publishing-created**. Epictetus did not print those five letters. The ancients teach impression, judgment, what is in our power, assent, and examination.[S1][S2][S11][S7] This series wraps those doctrines in a loop you can run without a seminar.

The gym is ordinary life. Not catastrophe. Not a hunt for your “real wound.” A scene from this week is enough.

If you already “know Stoicism” as quotations, this book will still require writing. Knowledge that does not change the next act is not the skill this title installs.

Phase	Chapters	What you gain
Orient	1	Five moves named; practice over collecting quotes
SEE	2	Impression literacy; Incident Capture
SORT	3–4	Fact vs judgment; Control Sort
Pause	5	Assent Pause
OWN	6	Accurate share; no self-prosecution
CHOOSE	7	One virtue-tested next act (light Virtue Mirror)
REVIEW	8	Evening Examination as a habit
Integrate	close	Draft Personal Standard Card + 7-day plan

Book-specific tools (publishing-created): Five-Move Card · Incident Capture · Fact/Judgment Split

Series tools (taught here, reused later): Control Sort · Assent Pause · Evening Examination · Practice Commitment · Progress Mark · draft Personal Standard Card

Work in order. Later pages require earlier artifacts. Difficulty starts at foundation and climbs to examination — not to crisis.

Do not tidy this page to look composed. You will return to it in Integration.

When (this week):

Where / who (facts):

What happened (observable facts only — no motives, no "always," no verdict):

What you did next (facts):

You will run the full method on this scene at the end of the book. Do not rewrite it now to look better.

Chapter 1

Start With the Method

After this chapter you can: *name the five moves of this Collection's method in your own words — and tell the difference between collecting quotes and practicing.*

> *On no occasion call yourself a philosopher, and do not speak much among the uninstructed about theorems (philosophical rules, precepts): but do that which follows from them. For example at a banquet do not say how a man ought to eat, but eat as you ought to eat.*
>
> — Epictetus, Enchiridion 46, trans. George Long (1890) [S10]

Epictetus does not treat philosophy as a costume. Theorems that are not digested into acts are something you can recite — and vomit up — without having used them.[S10]

This Collection is built for the same test: **practice over information**.

You may already own a quote book. You may already know that some things are “up to you.” Knowing the sentence is not the same as running a loop when a short email lands and your chest tightens.

What the Collection trains: judgment, control, and assent as skills you can repeat. Not a personality. Not a brand of calm.

Three labels you will see throughout:

Label	Meaning
Classical	Attested Stoic teaching (impression, opinion, dichotomy, assent, virtue, evening examination)
Modern	Later interpretation or practice note, marked when used
Publishing method	Tools this series invented to **apply** the classical teaching (SSOCR, Control Sort, Assent Pause, and the rest)

SSOCR is publishing method. Do not attribute the five-letter loop to Epictetus, Marcus, or Seneca.

This chapter does not yet teach Control Sort or Assent Pause. It installs the demand: a method is a loop you can run, not a stack of maxims.

Pages 7–8 — Lesson (continued)

PRINCIPLE

A method is what you can run on today's incident. A quote is what you can repeat without changing the next act.

Micro-example (composite)

Sam can recite "some things are up to us." Then a meeting starts five minutes late. Sam spends the hour narrating injustice and does not notice the impression, sort the scene, or choose one act. The quote was present. The method was not.

Prompt 1.1 (L1 / quote-habit)

Where, this month, have you collected Stoic lines (or any self-help lines) instead of practicing on a real scene? Name the scene.

Prompt 1.2 (L1 / incident-facts)

One ordinary incident from this week (not a disaster; not a hunt for your "real issue"). Facts only: when, where, who, what was said or done.

Pages 10–11 — L1 Awareness prompts (continued)

In this book, **method** means a loop you can run without flipping back through a lecture:

SEE the impression → SORT facts, judgments, and control → OWN your share → CHOOSE one act → REVIEW the day.

Prompt 1.3 (L2 / method-job)

Write, in one sentence, what “method” will mean for you here (not a slogan — a job):

FIVE-MOVE CARD (BOOK-SPECIFIC / encoding)

Write each move in **your** words, one line. Do not copy the table on page vi.

Move	In my words (one line)
SEE	
SORT	
OWN	
CHOOSE	
REVIEW	

This card is a publishing tool. It is how you encode the engine. It is not a classical text.

PRACTICE COMMITMENT (L6 / behavioral-commitment)

Notice one impression today. Do **not** try to fix the scene yet.

- **Cue:**

  _____

- **Act:** Notice the impression (write three words when it hits).
- **Evidence:**

  _____

- **Window:**

  _____

PROGRESS MARK

☐ I did the reading ☐ I wrote the incident ☐ I set the commitment

Date:

Takeaway (one line):

Hook: Next you will catch what hits the mind **before** the story starts.

Chapter 2

What Hits the Mind

After this chapter you can: *capture an impression as it strikes — before you treat it as a finished judgment.*

> *Straightway then practise saying to every harsh appearance, You are an appearance, and in no manner what you appear to be.*
>
> — Epictetus, Enchiridion 1, trans. George Long (1890) [S3]

An **impression** (**phantasia**) is what strikes the mind before you decide it is true: a thought, an image, a bodily jolt, a "take" that appears.[S3][S12]

It is not yet belief. Belief requires **assent** — agreement — which you will train to delay in Chapter 5.[S12] First you have to see the strike.

Epictetus trains a first move: treat a harsh appearance as an appearance, not as the thing it claims to be.[S3] You do not have to become numb. You have to stop confusing the first hit with a verdict.

Ordinary examples (not catastrophes):

- The typing-dots in a message, then silence
- Someone's tone in a two-line email
- A cup left in the sink
- Being interrupted in a meeting

The impression might be: **I'm being dismissed.** That may or may not be true. Chapter 2's job is to catch the appearance. Chapter 3 splits what you added.

Classical vs publishing: The doctrine of impressions is classical. **Incident Capture** is a publishing worksheet for catching them.

Pages 17–18 — Lesson (continued)

PRINCIPLE

You can notice the strike before you agree that it is the whole truth.

Micro-example (composite)

Riley sees a short reply: “k.” Chest tightens. The appearance is **they’re angry.** Riley has not yet checked facts, sorted control, or chosen an act. The work begins at the tightness and the first take — not at the novel Riley could write about it.

Prompt 2.1 (L1 / first-strike)

Last ordinary strike this week. What appeared **before** the story — body, thought, image, or "take"?

Body / sensation:

Thought or image:

The first take (one sentence):

Prompt 2.2 (L1 / before-the-story)

What did you do in the next sixty seconds? Facts only.

Pages 20–21 — L1 prompts (continued)

INCIDENT CAPTURE (BOOK-SPECIFIC / SEE skill)

Do **not** analyze motives. Do **not** diagnose your character. Capture the scene.

Time / date:

Place / people (facts):

Facts (what a camera would record):

First appearance (impression):

What you did next (facts):

Keep this page. Chapter 3 will split it. Chapter 4 will sort it.

Pages 22–23 — INCIDENT CAPTURE (continued)

PRACTICE COMMITMENT (L6 / behavioral-commitment)

- **Cue:**

  _____

- **Act:** Capture one live impression today (three lines: time, appearance, next act).
- **Evidence:**

  _____

- **Window:**

  _____

PROGRESS MARK

☐ I did the reading ☐ I wrote the incident ☐ I set the commitment

Date:

Takeaway (one line):

Hook: Next you will separate what happened from what you added.

Chapter 3

Facts and Additions

After this chapter you can: *split an ordinary incident into facts and added judgments — without turning the page into a character trial.*

> *Men are disturbed not by the things which happen, but by the opinions about the things.*
>
> — Epictetus, Enchiridion 5, trans. George Long (1890) [S2]

A **judgment** (opinion) is an evaluative belief about what happened — not "being judgmental" as a social insult.[S2]

Epictetus's point is blunt: disturbance follows opinions about events more than the events themselves.[S2] The meeting running long is a fact. **They don't respect me** is an addition until you have evidence and until you have assented.

You will **pause assent** as a full skill in Chapter 5. Here you only learn to see the seam: camera-facts vs the evaluation you glued on.

Worked T-chart (ordinary scene, composite):

Facts	Added judgments
The message arrived at 4:12. It contained one word: "k."	They're furious. They're done with me. I ruined it.
I sent my question at 3:40.	I was too much.

The left column can be checked. The right column may be true, false, or mixed — but it is not a fact until tested, and it is not yet a belief you must live inside.

This is not Book 2. You are not hunting a hidden pattern or an avoided truth. You are splitting one ordinary scene so later tools have clean material.

Pages 27–28 — Lesson (continued)

PRINCIPLE

If a camera could not record it, it is not a fact yet — it is an addition.

Use the model on page 28. Your T-chart is next.

FACT/JUDGMENT SPLIT (BOOK-SPECIFIC / SORT skill)

Use the Chapter 2 Incident Capture **or** a new ordinary incident from this week.

Incident in one line:

Facts (camera)	Added judgments (evaluations, mind-reading, always/never, verdicts)

Pages 30–32 — FACT/JUDGMENT SPLIT (continued)

Pages 30–32 — FACT/JUDGMENT SPLIT (continued)

Prompt 3.1 (L2 / additions)

Circle (or star) every addition in the right column that is **not** a fact. Then write the most expensive addition in one sentence — the one that most changed how you felt or acted.

PRACTICE COMMITMENT (L6 / behavioral-commitment)

- **Cue:**

_____

- **Act:** One live Fact/Judgment Split on today's incident (two columns, at least three lines each).
- **Evidence:**

_____

- **Window:**

_____

PROGRESS MARK

☐ I did the reading ☐ I wrote the incident ☐ I set the commitment

Date:

Takeaway (one line):

Hook: Next you will sort what is up to you — including the judgment you just found.

Chapter 4

Up to You

After this chapter you can: *run Control Sort on an ordinary incident — three columns — without pretending you control everything or nothing.*

> *Of things some are in our power, and others are not. In our power are opinion (ὑπόληψις), movement towards a thing (ὁρμή), desire, aversion (ἔκκλισις, turning from a thing); and in a word, whatever are our own acts: not in our power are the body, property, reputation, offices (magisterial power), and in a word, whatever are not our own acts.*
>
> — Epictetus, Enchiridion 1, trans. George Long (1890) [S1]

The **dichotomy of control** is classical: some things are in our power; others are not.[S1] In our power: opinion, impulse, desire, aversion, and our own acts. Not in our power: body, property, reputation, office, and whatever is not our own act.[S1]

Two folklore errors to kill here:

- **"I control everything if I try harder."** You do not control other people's replies, the clock, or your reputation. Fighting the unmovable is not discipline. It is a category error.
- **"Nothing is up to me, so I am off the hook."** Your opinions and acts remain yours. Nihilism is not Stoicism.

Control Sort is a publishing worksheet with three columns: **Up to me** | **Not up to me** | **My share**.

Label this clearly: "My share" is a **teaching aid** for mixed cases (you cannot control the delay; you can control the follow-up you send). It is **not** a third ontological category in Epictetus.[S1] Classical teaching remains two-sided. The third column exists so you do not dump a mixed scene into "not mine" and walk away, and so you do not swallow the whole scene as "all mine."

On a first pass, "my share" may be thin. That is allowed. Chapter 6 will require it to be non-empty.

Pages 37–38 — Lesson (continued)

PRINCIPLE

Sort the scene before you spend yourself on what will not move.

CONTROL SORT (PERMANENT — first teach)

Use the Chapter 3 incident (or a new ordinary incident). “My share” may be thin this time.

Incident in one line:

Up to me (opinion, impulse, my acts)	Not up to me (body, others, timing, reputation, office…)	My share (teaching aid — mixed cases)

Reminder: Column three is series pedagogy, not a third classical category.[S1]

Pages 40–42 — CONTROL SORT (continued)

Pages 40–42 — CONTROL SORT (continued)

Prompt 4.1 (L2 / unmovable)

What were you trying to move that is not yours? One sentence.

Prompt 4.2 (L4 / first-share)

If “my share” is thin, write the smallest act or opinion that still belongs to you in this scene.

PRACTICE COMMITMENT (L6 / behavioral-commitment)

- **Cue:**

  _____

- **Act:** One live Control Sort today (three columns filled; even a thin “my share”).
- **Evidence:**

  _____

- **Window:**

  _____

PROGRESS MARK

☐ I did the reading ☐ I wrote the incident ☐ I set the commitment

Date:

Takeaway (one line):

Hook: Next you will delay agreement with the first impression.

Chapter 5

Before You Assent

After this chapter you can: *run Assent Pause on a live ordinary trigger — Impression → Pause → Remainder.*

> *But in the first place be not hurried away by the rapidity of the appearance, but say, Appearances, wait for me a little: let me see who you are, and what you are about: let me put you to the test.*
>
> — Epictetus, Discourses 2.18, trans. George Long (1890) [S11]

Assent (**sunkatathesis**) is the act of agreeing with an impression so it becomes a believed judgment.[S12] Humans can examine appearances as true or false; that capacity is what makes the pause possible.[S12]

Epictetus trains not being swept off by the speed of the appearance: wait, see what it is, put it to the test.[S11] **Assent Pause** is the series box for that training. The box is publishing-created. The doctrine is not.

Why we agree too fast: **desire** and **aversion** — the impulse toward what we want and away from what we dislike — make some appearances feel urgent.[S4] Beginners are taught to relocate aversion and to restrain desire for what is not in their power.[S4] That is not a command to erase all human wanting. Feeling may remain while you delay the **agreement**.[S12]

Do not turn this chapter into a driver map. You are not cataloging what you chase and flee as Book 2 will. You are answering one question: **Did I agree with the first take before I tested it?**

What is your own, in Epictetus's line, includes the **use of appearances**.[S14] The pause is how you use them instead of being used by them.

Pages 47–48 — Lesson (continued)

PRINCIPLE

Impression → Pause → Remainder. The remainder is what you have not yet agreed to.

Micro-example (composite)

The appearance: **This delay means I'm not valued.**

Pause: three breaths; "Wait — appearance."

Remainder (unassented): **A delay happened. I have not yet agreed that it means my worth.**

ASSENT PAUSE (PERMANENT — first teach)

Use a live ordinary trigger (this week). Not a catastrophe. Not an "avoided truth" hunt.

1. Impression (what struck):

2. Pause (what you actually did — breaths, a phrase, a delay before sending):

3. Remainder (what remains if you do not agree yet):

The test (one line): What would I need to know before this appearance gets to be a belief?

Pages 50–52 — ASSENT PAUSE (continued)

Pages 50–52 — ASSENT PAUSE (continued)

Prompt 5.1 (L4 / almost-agreed)

What did you almost agree with? What remains after the pause?

Almost-agreed:

Remainder:

PRACTICE COMMITMENT (L6 / behavioral-commitment)

- **Cue:**

  _____

- **Act:** Catch one assent today; pause once (write Impression / Pause / Remainder).
- **Evidence:**

  _____

- **Window:**

  _____

PROGRESS MARK

☐ I did the reading ☐ I wrote the incident ☐ I set the commitment

Date:

Takeaway (one line):

Hook: Next you will own your share without prosecuting yourself.

Chapter 6

Ownership Without Abuse

After this chapter you can: *name a non-empty "my share" on a new ordinary incident — and drop what was never yours — without turning ownership into self-abuse.*

> *It is the act of an ill-instructed man to blame others for his own bad condition; it is the act of one who has begun to be instructed, to lay the blame on himself; and of one whose instruction is completed, neither to blame another, nor himself.*
>
> — Epictetus, Enchiridion 5, trans. George Long (1890) [S2]

Epictetus maps three stages: blame others; then blame yourself; then, when instruction is completed, blame neither.[S2] This book is not claiming you are "complete." It is claiming that **accurate ownership** is not a war on the self.

Own: the opinion you assented to; the act you chose; the follow-up that was yours.[S1][S2]

Do not own: other people's minds, the past as if you could rewind it, a total verdict on your worth.

Self-prosecution ("I am the problem, always") is the beginner move of blaming oneself as a new identity. It is not the completed move. Evening Examination (Chapter 8) will **correct**; it will not indict.

Reuse Control Sort here on a **new** ordinary incident. Column three must not be empty. If you cannot find a share, you are still dumping or still swallowing. Look again: one opinion, one act, one sentence you will send, one pause you skipped.

"Responsibility," as this series uses it, is accurate attribution of assent and action. That emphasis is ours. The dichotomy underneath it is classical.[S1]

Pages 57–58 — Lesson (continued)

PRINCIPLE

Own the share. Drop the rest. Do not promote either into a life sentence.

CONTROL SORT — new ordinary incident (my share must be non-empty)

Incident in one line:

Up to me	Not up to me	My share (required — at least one specific opinion or act)

If “my share” is still empty, you are not done. Write the smallest true share here:

Pages 60–62 — CONTROL SORT (reuse) (continued)

Pages 60–62 — CONTROL SORT (reuse) (continued)

Prompt 6.1 (L4 / release)

What were you carrying that was never yours? Release it in one sentence.

Prompt 6.2 (L5 / keep)

What will you keep as yours — one opinion or one act — and perform inside the Practice Commitment window?

PRACTICE COMMITMENT (L6 / behavioral-commitment)

- **Cue:**

  _____

- **Act:** One owned act (observable) in a defined window.
- **Evidence:**

  _____

- **Window:**

  _____

PROGRESS MARK

☐ I did the reading ☐ I wrote the incident ☐ I set the commitment

Date:

Takeaway (one line):

Hook: Next you will test the next act against virtue — not against a personality label.

Chapter 7

Virtue Tests the Next Act

After this chapter you can: *run a light Virtue Mirror on one ordinary scene and name one next act the mirror requires.*

> *Not in passivity, but in activity lie the evil and the good of the rational social animal, just as his virtue and his vice lie not in passivity, but in activity.*
>
> — Marcus Aurelius, Meditations 9.16, trans. George Long (1890) [S5]

Marcus locates good and evil — and virtue and vice — in **activity**, not passivity.[S5] A well-worded page that never becomes an act is incomplete for this book's purpose.

The four cardinal virtues in the Stoic taxonomy are **wisdom, justice, courage, and temperance** (moderation).[S6][S13] In this Collection they function as **action tests**, not personality labels. "Action tests" is series pedagogy. The four names are classical ethics. Marcus's sentence supports activity, not a slogan that "virtue is a quiz."[S5][S6]

Virtue	Test of the next act
Wisdom	What is actually going on? What is good, bad, or indifferent here?
Justice	What is owed — in this role, to these people — without martyrdom?
Courage	What ordinary difficulty am I postponing that virtue requires?
Temperance	What impulse needs measure — including the urge to self-punish?

This is a **light Virtue Mirror**, not a Character Audit. You will not catalog your life. You will score **one ordinary scene** and choose **one next act**.

Pages 67–68 — Lesson (continued)

PRINCIPLE

Virtue is proven in the next act, not in the identity you prefer.

Micro-example (composite)

The scene: a task promised for Friday, still undone Thursday night. Wisdom: the deadline is real. Justice: others are waiting on the file. Courage: start the ugly first section tonight. Temperance: no three-hour self-attack; forty focused minutes. The next act is the forty minutes — not a new self-image.

VIRTUE MIRROR (ADAPTABLE — light checkpoint only)

Ordinary scene (one):

Virtue	Expressed in this scene? (how / not)	Failed or missing? (how)
Wisdom		
Justice		
Courage		
Temperance		

Forbidden on this page: a character catalog; a hunt for hidden patterns; Band III heat.

Pages 70–72 — VIRTUE MIRROR (light) (continued)

Pages 70–72 — VIRTUE MIRROR (light) (continued)

Prompt 7.1 (L5 / next-act)

Name one next act the mirror requires. Observable. Time-bound. Not “be better.”

PRACTICE COMMITMENT (L6 / behavioral-commitment)

- **Cue:**

_____

- **Act:** Perform that next act in 24–48 hours (copy from p. 73).
- **Evidence:** (required)

_____

- **Window:** 24–48 hours from: _____

PROGRESS MARK

☐ I did the reading ☐ I wrote the incident ☐ I set the commitment

Date:

Takeaway (one line):

Hook: Next you will review the day until review is ordinary — not theatrical.

Chapter 8

Review Until It Is Ordinary

After this chapter you can: *run the series Evening Examination on today's ordinary incidents and extract one correction for tomorrow.*

> *It was the custom of Sextius when the day was over, and he had betaken himself to rest, to inquire of his spirit: "What bad habit of yours have you cured to-day? what vice have you checked? in what respect are you better?"*
>
> — Seneca, De Ira (Of Anger) 3.36, trans. Aubrey Stewart (1889) [S7]

Seneca describes a nightly practice: the spirit is examined; Sextius asks what was cured, checked, and improved; Seneca reviews the day's words and deeds without concealment, then sleeps.[S7]

That is the **classical self-examination tradition**. It is not a command to prosecute yourself. Correction follows the review. Concealment is the failure.

Evening Examination in this Collection is a **publishing form** — three questions aimed at method literacy. Inspired by the tradition. Not identical with Seneca's wording. Do not tell anyone "the Stoics invented this worksheet."

Series questions (lock this function):

- What impression did I notice, and what did I add?
- What was up to me, and did I own my share?
- What one act will I choose tomorrow?

Question 3 is a method/practice focus: one act, not a personality overhaul.

You already closed Chapters 1–7 with a Progress Mark so this form would not become a slogan before you had incidents. Tonight it becomes a skill.

Optional classical texture (same chapter, not a second epigraph):

> *I pass the whole day in review before myself, and repeat all that I have said and done: I conceal nothing from myself, and omit nothing.*
>
> — Seneca, De Ira 3.36, trans. Aubrey Stewart (1889) [S7]

Use that as a standard of honesty, not as a license to self-attack.

Pages 77–78 — Lesson (continued)

PRINCIPLE

Review to correct. Do not review to prosecute.

EVENING EXAMINATION (PERMANENT — first full teach)

Use **today's ordinary incidents**. If the day is thin, use the incident you have been carrying since Chapter 2.

Date:

1. What impression did I notice, and what did I add?

Impression:

What I added:

2. What was up to me, and did I own my share?

Up to me:

My share (owned / skipped):

3. What one act will I choose tomorrow?

Pages 80–82 — EVENING EXAMINATION (continued)

Pages 80–82 — EVENING EXAMINATION (continued)

Prompt 8.1 (L5–L6 / correction)

Tomorrow’s one correction (copy or tighten Q3). Observable.

PRACTICE COMMITMENT (L6 / behavioral-commitment)

- **Cue:** End of day / lights out / after dishes (pick one).
- **Act:** Run Evening Examination tonight (all three questions written).
- **Evidence:**

  _____

- **Window:** Tonight.

PROGRESS MARK

☐ I did the reading ☐ I wrote the incident ☐ I set the commitment

Date:

Takeaway (one line):

Hook: Next you will draft a Personal Standard you can carry — not a diploma.

INTEGRATION — A Standard You Can Carry

Completion here does not mean you have finished Stoicism. It means you have a method you can run on ordinary incidents.

You named the engine, caught impressions, split facts from additions, sorted control, paused assent, owned a share without self-abuse, tested one act against virtue, and reviewed a day.[S1][S2][S5][S7][S10][S11]

What remains is portable language — a **draft**. Book 2 can finalize a standard under examination pressure. This book does not pretend you are done.

Return to **page 5**. Do not erase the old facts.

Old incident (p. 5) in one line:

Run SSOCR on it now (short):

Move	Now (not a lecture — what you would actually do)
SEE	
SORT	
OWN	
CHOOSE	
REVIEW	

What changed in **method** (not mood) since page 5?

PERSONAL STANDARD CARD — DRAFT (L7 / draft-standard)

This card is a publishing tool. It is **not** finalized. Date it as a draft.

My SEE: When happens, I will notice .

My SORT: I will separate facts from judgments by , and use Control Sort when .

My OWN: I own . I release .

My CHOOSE: In the next act I will test (virtue) by doing .

My REVIEW: Each evening I will ask the three Evening Examination questions.

Book 1 line (ordinary incidents):

On ordinary scenes this week, my standard is:

Draft date: Not a finalization date.

Pages 88–89 — PERSONAL STANDARD CARD (DRAFT) (continued)

One method act per day. Ordinary incidents. Observable.

Day	Cue	One method act (SEE / SORT / Pause / OWN / CHOOSE / REVIEW)	Done?
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Date	Impression noticed / what I added	Up to me / did I own my share?	Tomorrow’s one act

(Classical inspiration: Seneca’s daily self-scrutiny in De Ira **3.36.[S7] This table is the series form.)**

Classical vs modern vs publishing — final reminder

Classical	Publishing / modern
Impressions, opinions, dichotomy, assent, use of appearances, virtues in activity, evening examination tradition	SSOCR, Control Sort “my share,” Assent Pause box, Five-Move Card, Incident Capture, Fact/Judgment Split, Practice Commitment fields, draft Personal Standard Card, series Evening Examination wording

Use the **Stoic Terminology & Concepts Guide** for definitions. Use **Sources & Citations** to trace quotations and claims. Use **Further Reading** if you want primary texts and scholarship — not as decoration.

This book did not give you more quotes. It gave you a method you can run on today’s incidents.

Now that you can run the method, you can aim it at what you usually avoid seeing.

That is Book 2 — **Stoic Shadow Work Journal**. Same engine. Different pressure: hidden patterns, avoidance, self-deception. You are not required to buy it to have "finished" this one. You are invited because the tools are now installed.

No guilt for owning one book. No fake catalog of later ASINs. Keep practicing on ordinary incidents until the loop is boring. Then, if you want heat, take the loop where you flinch.

This guide defines terms used in this book in plain language.

Where needed, it separates **classical meaning** from **modern / series usage**.

Key:

- **Classical** — attested Stoic teaching / standard scholarly sense
- **In this book** — how you practiced it here
- **Citation** — see Sources & Citations keys

Impression (phantasia)

Reader definition: What strikes the mind before you decide it is true — a thought, image, bodily jolt, or "take" that appears.

Classical: The appearance presented to the mind; Epictetus trains treating harsh appearances as appearances first.[S3][S12]

In this book: Incident Capture in Chapter 2.

Citation: [S1], [S3], [S12]

Assent (sunkatathesis)

Reader definition: The act of agreeing with an impression so it becomes a believed judgment.

Classical: Faculty of examining impressions as true or false; humans can wait and test appearances.[S12][S11]

In this book: What Assent Pause interrupts. The Pause **box** is a series method.

Citation: [S11], [S12], [S14]

Judgment / opinion

Reader definition: An evaluative belief about what happened — not merely "being judgmental" as a social insult.

Classical: Opinions about things shape disturbance.[S2]

In this book: The right column of the Fact/Judgment Split.

Citation: [S2]

Dichotomy of control

Reader definition: Some things are in our power; others are not.

Classical: Enchiridion 1 — opinion, impulse, desire, aversion, and our acts vs body, property, reputation, office, etc.[S1]

In this book: Foundation of Control Sort. The "my share" column is a **teaching aid** for mixed cases, not a third classical category.

Citation: [S1]

Desire / Aversion

Reader definition: The impulse toward what you want and away from what you fear or dislike.

Classical: Train these faculties; beginners are told to restrain desire for what is not in their power and to relocate aversion.[S4]

In this book: Why assent is fast (Chapter 5) — not a full driver map. Feeling may remain while you delay agreement.[S12]

Citation: [S4]

Virtue

Reader definition: Excellence of rational agency expressed in action; for Stoics, the moral good.

Classical: Virtue and vice show in activity, not passivity.[S5] Four cardinal types: wisdom, justice, courage, temperance/moderation.[S6][S13]

In this book: Tests for the next act (light Virtue Mirror). “Action tests” is series pedagogy.

Citation: [S5], [S6], [S13]

Wisdom

Reader definition: Sound judgment about what is good, bad, and indifferent in a situation.

Classical: One of the four cardinal virtues.[S6][S13]

In this book: Virtue Mirror — “What is actually going on?”

Citation: [S5], [S6]

Courage

Reader definition: Right endurance and daring for the sake of virtue — including ordinary difficulty, not only heroics.

Classical: Cardinal virtue; not recklessness.[S6][S13]

In this book: Starting the next act you would postpone.

Citation: [S5], [S6]

Justice

Reader definition: Giving what is owed in dealings and roles — without martyrdom or false guilt.

Classical: Cardinal social virtue.[S6][S13]

In this book: What the next act owes others and your roles.

Citation: [S5], [S6]

Temperance

Reader definition: Self-mastery regarding desire and impulse; measured response rather than indulgence or harsh self-punishment.

Classical: Cardinal virtue tied to training desire/aversion.[S4][S6]

In this book: Pause + measured act; no self-prosecution.

Citation: [S4], [S5], [S6]

Character

Reader definition: The settled disposition built by repeated judgments and acts.

Classical-compatible: Shown in activity.[S5]

In this book: Draft Personal Standard Card — not a personality quiz and not a Character Audit.

Citation: [S5]

Discipline

Reader definition: Trained choice — repeating the loop until it is available under ordinary friction.

Note: Series interpretation, not a single ancient slogan line.

In this book: Practice Commitments with evidence.

Responsibility (as used here)

Reader definition: Accurate ownership of your judgments and acts — without false guilt for what was never yours.

Note: Emphasis is series interpretation built on the dichotomy of control and **Ench.** 5's completed instruction.[S1][S2]

Self-examination / evening review tradition

Reader definition: A daily practice of reviewing acts and faults without concealment.

Classical: Seneca describes daily examination, including Sextius's questions and his own review of words and deeds.[S7]

In this book: Evening Examination (series three-question form).

Citation: [S7]

SEE → SORT → OWN → CHOOSE → REVIEW (SSOCR)

Reader definition: The Collection's portable loop.

Classification: Publishing-created. Not a classical technical term.

Control Sort / Assent Pause / Evening Examination

Reader definition: Series worksheets for dichotomy, delayed agreement, and nightly correction.

Classification: Publishing-created. "My share" is a teaching aid. Evening Examination wording is series form.

The following are **UnlovedProductions / The Stoic Collection frameworks**. They organize practice. They are **not** ancient Stoic texts and must not be attributed to Epictetus, Marcus, or Seneca:

- SEE → SORT → OWN → CHOOSE → REVIEW (SSOCR)
- Control Sort (including “my share” teaching column)
- Assent Pause
- Evening Examination (series three-question form)
- Practice Commitment
- Progress Mark
- Five-Move Card
- Incident Capture
- Fact/Judgment Split
- Personal Standard Card (draft in this book)
- Virtue Mirror (light checkpoint)
- Re-entry Page
- Principle Callout

Classical sources supply the doctrines these tools apply.[S1][S2][S3][S4][S5][S7][S10][S11][S14]

- **On-page quotes** include author, work, section, translator, and year.
- **Keys** like [S1] mark load-bearing paraphrases and glossary anchors.
- Full entries appear below.
- Popular unverified internet quotations are excluded.

Quote policy: Direct quotations use US public-domain translations locked in the Book 1 Source Verification Report (2026-08-20). Modern copyrighted translations (Hard, Hays, Graver & Long **Letters**) are not quoted in this edition.

Key	Work
[S1]	Epictetus, **Enchiridion** 1, trans. George Long (1890) — dichotomy
[S2]	Epictetus, **Enchiridion** 5, trans. George Long (1890) — opinions; completed instruction
[S3]	Epictetus, **Enchiridion** 1 (appearance-practice lines), Long (1890)
[S4]	Epictetus, **Enchiridion** 2, trans. George Long (1890) — desire/aversion
[S5]	Marcus Aurelius, **Meditations** 9.16, trans. George Long (1890)
[S6]	Stoic cardinal virtues — Sellars, **Stoicism**; Brennan, **The Stoic Life**; IEP "Stoic Ethics"
[S7]	Seneca, **De Ira** 3.36, trans. Aubrey Stewart (1889)
[S8]	Graver, **Stoicism and Emotion** (2007) — Further Reading; not quoted as ancient
[S9]	A. A. Long, **Epictetus: A Stoic and Socratic Guide to Life** (2002) — Further Reading
[S10]	Epictetus, **Enchiridion** 46, trans. George Long (1890)
[S11]	Epictetus, **Discourses** 2.18, trans. George Long (1890)

[S12]	Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy, “Epictetus” — assent / use of impressions (secondary)
[S13]	Internet Encyclopedia of Philosophy, “Stoic Ethics” — four-virtue taxonomy (secondary)
[S14]	Epictetus, **Enchiridion** 6, trans. George Long (1890) — use of appearances

Primary texts (quoted)

Epictetus. **The Discourses of Epictetus, with the Encheiridion and Fragments.** Translated by George Long. London: George Bell and Sons, 1890.

Marcus Aurelius. **Meditations.** Translated by George Long. 19th-c. US public-domain translation (this edition quotes 9.16). Access copy used for verification: Lexundria Long Book 9 §16.

Seneca. **Of Anger** (**De Ira**), Book III, ch. 36. In **Minor Dialogues Together with the Dialogue On Clemency.** Translated by Aubrey Stewart. London: George Bell and Sons, 1889. Project Gutenberg #64576.

Scholarly secondaries (used for glossary / virtue taxonomy, not quoted as ancients)

Sellars, John. **Stoicism.** 1st ed. University of California Press / Acumen / Routledge, 2006 (ISBN-13 978-0-520-24908-0 / 978-1-84465-053-8). 2nd ed. Routledge (ISBN 978-1-032-78149-5).

Brennan, Tad. **The Stoic Life: Emotions, Duties, and Fate.** Oxford: Clarendon / Oxford University Press, 2005. ISBN-13 978-0-19-925626-6.

“Epictetus.” **Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy.**

“Stoic Ethics.” **Internet Encyclopedia of Philosophy.**

Not quoted (copyrighted; optional purchase only)

Robin Hard (Oxford) translations; Gregory Hays, **Meditations** (Modern Library, 2002); Margaret Graver & A. A. Long, Seneca **Letters**.

Chapter-opening quotations were verified against Perseus, Wikisource, Lexundria, and Gutenberg access copies of the Long and Stewart translations (Book 1 Source Verification Report, 2026-08-20). Popular web quote images and unsourced “Stoic proverbs” are excluded unless they match a locked block with work, section, translator, and year.

Typesetting must re-diff each opening quote against those source URLs before print PDF (OCR drift).

Read these after this book if you want the pages behind the quotes. Prefer the same translators you met in the interior so the wording matches.

• **Epictetus,** Enchiridion **and** Discourses **— George Long (1890). Public domain. Use this for continuity with the openings. Hard (Oxford) is a modern purchase option;** do not mix Hard phrasing into this workbook's quotes.

• **Marcus Aurelius,** Meditations **— George Long. Public domain. Hays (Modern Library, 2002) is readable modern English and** copyrighted — optional as a second copy, not a quote source for this title.

• **Seneca,** De Ira **(**Of Anger**)** — Aubrey Stewart (1889), Gutenberg #64576. For letters, buy a named modern edition; this book does not quote them.

Why these help **after** Book 1: they explain the psychology and ethics you just practiced, without replacing the loop.

- **John Sellars,** Stoicism (2006; 2nd ed. later) — Clear map of logic, physics, ethics; use for the four virtues and system context.[S6]
- **Tad Brennan,** The Stoic Life (OUP, 2005) — Emotions, duties, fate at a serious introductory level.[S6]
- **A. A. Long,** Epictetus: A Stoic and Socratic Guide to Life (Clarendon / OUP, 2002; ISBN 0-19-924556-8 / 978-0-19-924556-7) — How Epictetus teaches; useful after you have used impressions in practice.[S9]
- **Margaret Graver,** Stoicism and Emotion (University of Chicago Press, 2007; cloth ISBN-13 978-0-226-30557-8) — If you still hear "Stoic" as "no feeling"; this is scholarship, not a workbook.[S8]

These are **modern practice books**. They are not classical texts. They are not this Collection's engine.

- William B. Irvine, **A Guide to the Good Life: The Ancient Art of Stoic Joy** (Oxford University Press, 2008; ISBN 0-19-537461-4) — Popular modern Stoic practice.
- Donald J. Robertson, **How to Think Like a Roman Emperor** (St. Martin's Press, 2019; ISBN 978-1-250-19662-0) — Biography plus modern CBT-adjacent technique. **Do not** treat as proof that "the Stoics invented CBT."

If a later page in your life needs clinical care, get clinical care. These titles do not authorize this workbook as therapy.

The Stoic Collection

Book	Title	Job
1 (this book)	**Stoic Foundations**	Install the method
2	**Stoic Shadow Work Journal**	Aim the method at hidden patterns / avoidance

No speculative later catalog. No fake ASINs.

UnlovedProductions

The Stoic Collection

Continue practice on ordinary incidents until the five moves are available without this book in your hand. That is the success of Book 1.

Tied to the **draft** Personal Standard Card (pp. 88–89). Six prompts maximum. Not blank filler.

- **(L7 / integration-cue)** One ordinary cue I will treat as SEE practice this week: _____
- **(L7 / integration-addition)** The addition I most often glue onto facts: _____
- **(L7 / integration-unmovable)** The unmovable I will stop fighting: _____
- **(L7 / integration-share)** The share I will own without abuse: _____
- **(L7 / integration-act)** The next act virtue requires (copy from Ch7 if still true): _____
- **(L7 / integration-review)** The time I will run Evening Examination: _____